

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal research, document drafting, case file management and client-facing advisory work at BCLP, Q-Legal, Citizens Advice and Adobe. Experienced in translating complex legal and regulatory material into clear, commercially focused written outputs. Developing interest in financial markets and transactional finance work, pursued through self-directed study and engagement with market-leading firms. Looking to apply research, drafting and knowledge-management skills within a global finance practice.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial scholarship toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

A&O Shearman Open Day / Self-Directed Finance Study · London Aug 2026 – ongoing

Firm Engagement and Continuing Development

- Attended A&O Shearman open day: private equity session and finance workshop covering how practice groups contribute to a PE transaction and security structures taken by lenders, including aircraft and ship financing
- Completed Coursera private equity course (self-directed): fund structures, investment selection, leverage, value creation and exit strategies
- Completed Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance virtual experience programme: applied financing and security concepts in a transactional real estate finance context

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for clients, including in sensitive and high-stakes situations

Q-Legal · London Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including obligations relating to children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Drafted procedural histories, procedural orders and sections of the Claimant's memorial for a complex investment arbitration
- Conducted legal research and reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage across several matters with competing deadlines; managed large volumes of confidential documents
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements; reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures to a mixed legal and non-legal audience

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document drafting and review; qualitative interviewing; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters